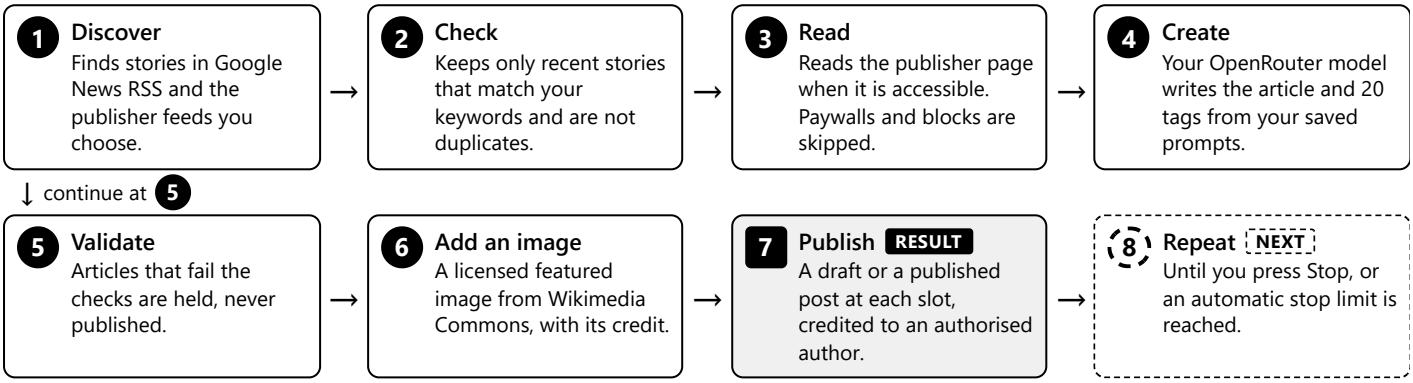
InkRush

Discover. Create. Publish.

User Guide. Every feature, every setting and every button, with numbered steps. For InkRush version 1.9.0 on WordPress.

1 Plugin overview

InkRush is an AI-powered WordPress news automation plugin for one site. You set it up once and press **Start Automation**. It then keeps working in the background, even with the browser closed, until you stop or pause it.



Main capabilities

- **News sources:** 21 ready-made categories, each with its own Google News topics, searches, publisher feeds, keywords, recency, language, region and days.
- **AI writing:** through OpenRouter only, with your own key, model and prompts. Prompt versions can be restored.
- **Scheduling:** daily target, interval, timezone, daily maximum, category rotation, Past-Hour Posting and an automatic stop.
- **Publishing:** Draft or Automatic Publish, per category if you like, with WordPress category mapping and tags.
- **Authors:** only users you authorise can be credited with posts.
- **Featured images:** required on every post, licensed, credited and never repeated.
- **Monitoring:** a live Dashboard, an Articles list with retry and skip, AI usage and cost, and filterable logs with CSV export.

Before you begin

- WordPress 6.5 or later, PHP 8.1 or later, one site (not network-wide).
- An **OpenRouter account** with an API key and credits. You pay OpenRouter for every request.
- A WordPress user to credit with posts.
- Recommended: access to your server's cron, for reliable timing (**F14**).

Your responsibility

- You are responsible for what is published. A story or image being public does not make it free to republish.
- Review AI-written articles for accuracy, especially in Automatic Publish mode.

How to read this guide

- **1** A step you do. Follow the numbers in order.
- **3** A decision. Its paths are numbered 3a, 3b.
- **INPUT** Information you type or choose.
- **Required** Must be set before automation can start.
- Optional Skip it if you do not need it. The default works.
- Fixed Shown on the page, but cannot be changed.
- **2a** An alternative path. Choose the one that fits.
- **4** **RESULT** What you see after the step.
- **5** **NEXT** Where to go next.
- **Recommended** Set it for the intended result.
- **Conditional** Only needed in the situation named.
- **4.2** Detail of step 4. The numbers in each settings table match its diagram.

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2 Complete feature map

Everything is under the InkRush menu in the WordPress admin. Each page has the same navigation bar at the top, so you can move between pages at any time. F1 to F25 are the features in this guide.

WordPress admin → InkRush menu
Ten pages, in menu order. Only administrators (users who can manage options) see them.

↓

Da Dashboard
- F19 Start, Stop, Pause, Resume
- F20 Live figures, worker health, Past-Hour table, images, errors, activity

NS News Sources
- F5 Categories: add, edit, test search, duplicate, delete, order, enable
- F6 Source and duplicate rules

AI AI Settings
- F2 OpenRouter key and test
- F3 Model and limits, prompts, prompt history
- F4 Test generation and test draft

Sc Schedule
- F11 Slots and publishing schedule
- F12 Past-Hour Posting
- F13 Rotation and research
- F15 Automatic stop
- F14 Server cron and token

Pu Publishing
- F9 Post creation and post author
- F9 WordPress category mapping
- F24 Data retention and removal

Au Authors
- F7 Search and filter users
- F7 Grant, pause, resume or revoke access, one by one or in bulk
- F8 Posting mode, and a schedule for each author

Im Images
- F10 Search, quality, license and credit settings
- F18 Test connection, preview search, retry image, history, release, image log

Ar Articles
- F16 Filter the list, open an article, Retry, Skip, Retry image

Us Usage
- F21 OpenRouter tokens and reported cost, image totals, request history

Lo Logs
- F17 Filter all events
- F17 Export CSV

Outside the InkRush menu: F1 Install, upgrade and activate (WordPress Plugins page) · F25 Deactivate or delete (Plugins page) · F22 Review drafts and posts (WordPress Posts) · F23 Advanced: stronger key protection in `wp-config.php`.

The first-time setup path: follow the numbers once

1 Plugins page
Install and activate (F1).

→

2 AI Settings INPUT
Save the API key, Test API Connection (F2).

→

3 News Sources
Review the 21 categories. Disable the ones you do not want (F5).

→

4 Authors INPUT
Grant access to the user to credit (F7).

↓ continue at 5

5 Publishing INPUT
Choose the Post author and the Publishing mode (F9).

→

6 Schedule
Check the timezone, times and limits (F11 to F15).

→

7 Dashboard
Press Start Automation (F19).

→

8 Dashboard RESULT
Running. Watch the figures and Logs (F20, F17).

> Only steps 2, 4 and 5 are strictly required on a new site: an API key, an active author, and that author chosen as Post author. Everything else starts with working defaults. To let several authors post on their own schedules, see F8 after this setup. If something is missing, the Dashboard lists it under "Needed before you can start" (see Section 8).

How the pages work together

From	Feeds into	How
NS	Schedule, Publishing	Each enabled category is a source of stories. Rotation on Schedule decides which category fills each slot. Publishing maps each category to a WordPress category and, if you like, its own mode.
AI	Articles, Usage	The key, model and prompts write every article. Each request appears in Usage, and each article in Articles.
Au	Publishing	Only an Active author can be chosen as Post author. Pausing or revoking that author stops posts until it is fixed. In Multiple users mode (F8), each author's own schedule decides when they post.
Im	Articles, Dashboard	No usable image means the article is held. It shows in Articles under Failed or held, and on the Dashboard.
Sc	Dashboard	Slot times, Past-Hour Posting and the automatic stop decide when posts appear. The Dashboard shows the next slot and the stop limits.

From	Feeds into	How
Ar	Logs	Every step of every article is written to Logs. An article's own history is at the bottom of its Articles page.

3 Feature catalogue

All 25 features at a glance. Each has its own numbered workflow and settings in Section 4.

No.	Feature, and where	What you can do	Main controls	Result
F1	**Install, upgrade, activate** Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin	Add the plugin, or replace an older version keeping all data	Install Now, Replace current with uploaded, Activate	InkRush menu with defaults
F2	**OpenRouter connection** AI Settings	Save, test, replace or remove your API key	Save key, Test API Connection, Remove key	Masked saved key, test message
F3	**Model, limits and prompts** AI Settings	Choose the model, length and tag rules, edit prompts, restore older prompt versions	Save AI settings, Restore	New prompt version is active
F4	**Test generation** AI Settings > Test generation	Try your prompts on sample text, and save the result as a draft	Run test generation, Create test draft	Article, tags, checks and cost; optional draft
F5	**News categories** News Sources	Add, edit, test, duplicate, delete, reorder, enable or disable categories	Add category, Edit, Test search, Duplicate, Delete, Up, Down, Enabled	Ready categories in the list
F6	**Source and duplicate rules** News Sources	Turn Google News on or off, set word limits, request gaps and duplicate matching	Save changes	Rules used for every category
F7	**Authors** Authors	Choose who may be credited with posts	Filter, Grant access, Pause, Resume, Revoke, Apply to selected	Active authors
F8	**Multiple users mode** Authors > Posting mode, Schedule	Let several authors post, each on their own schedule, and be credited	Schedule, Save schedule, Save posting mode	Each author's times on Today's slots
F9	**Publishing settings** Publishing	Draft or Automatic Publish, tags, attribution, post author, category mapping	Save publishing settings	How posts are created
F10	**Image settings** Images	Set image search, quality, credit and CC BY-SA rules	Save image settings	Rules for every featured image
F11	**Publishing schedule** Schedule	Set daily target, interval, first time, timezone, daily maximum and catch-up	Save schedule	Today's slots table
F12	**Past-Hour Posting** Schedule	Post only very fresh stories, with a set maximum age	Use Past-Hour Posting, Save schedule	Past-Hour table on the Dashboard
F13	**Rotation and research** Schedule	Decide which category fills each slot, and how research runs	Save schedule	Category per slot
F14	**Server cron** Schedule > Server cron	Run the worker on time, every minute	Create new token	Dashboard: Server cron Active
F15	**Automatic stop** Schedule > Automatic stop	Stop after a number of days or published posts	Save automatic stop	Stops by itself, Dashboard notice
F16	**Articles** Articles	Review every story and article, retry, skip or retry its image	All, Queue, Failed or held, Published, Drafts, Skipped, Retry, Skip, Retry image	Article record, source, checks, preview, history
F17	**Logs and CSV export** Logs	Filter every event and download it	Apply filters, Clear, Export CSV	Filtered table, CSV file
F18	**Image tools and history** Images	Test Wikimedia, preview a search, fix posts without images, release an image	Test Wikimedia connection, Preview image search, Retry image, Release	Preview, history, image log
F19	**Automation controls** Dashboard	Start, stop, pause and resume research or publishing	Start Automation, Stop Automation, Pause/Resume Research, Pause/Resume Publishing, Resume	State badge: Running, Paused, Stopped
F20	**Dashboard monitoring** Dashboard	See today's figures, worker health, next slot and recent events	View usage, links to Schedule, Images, Articles	Refreshes every 30 seconds
F21	**Usage** Usage	See OpenRouter requests, tokens and reported cost, and image totals	Previous, Next	Today, This month, All time
F22	**Review drafts and posts** WordPress Posts	Approve drafts in Draft mode, edit any post	WordPress Publish button	Published post, with its featured image
F23	**Advanced options** Several pages	Stronger key protection, per-category mode, fine thresholds	See Section 6	Tuned behaviour
F24	**Data retention and removal** Publishing	Choose how long records are kept, and whether deleting removes data	Save publishing settings	Old records removed daily
F25	**Deactivate or delete** Plugins page	Turn the plugin off, or remove it	Deactivate, Delete	Data kept, unless you chose to delete it

> Import and sharing: InkRush has no import feature and no settings export or sharing feature. Each settings box saves with its own Save button, and "Unsaved changes" appears beside the button until you save. The only export is the Logs CSV (F17).

4 Feature workflows and settings

Each feature has a numbered diagram. Follow the numbers. Where a step configures settings, its table uses the same number with a decimal (3.1, 3.2 …), in the order the fields appear on the page. Settings marked Optional can be left at their defaults.

F1 Install, upgrade and activate

WordPress: Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin

Purpose. Put InkRush on your site, or replace an older version.

Result. The InkRush menu appears, with 21 categories, the default prompts and default settings ready.

You can. Install a new copy, or upgrade in place while keeping every setting, category, article and log.

Next. F2: save your API key.

1 Open Plugins > Add New
In the WordPress admin.

→

2 Upload Plugin INPUT
Choose the file `inkrush-1.9.0.zip`.

→

3 Install Now

→

4 Is InkRush already installed?

- **4a No: Activate Plugin**
  New site.
- **4b Yes: Replace current with uploaded**
  Press Stop Automation first (F19), and back up the database.

↓ continue at 5

5 InkRush menu appears RESULT
After an upgrade, database changes run by themselves.

→

6 Upgrade only: check, then Start
Look at the Dashboard and Logs, then press Start Automation.

→

7 Go to AI Settings NEXT
F2.

The folder inside the ZIP is always `zzz-copy-das-sobur`, the plugin's technical name. That is why an upgrade replaces the old version instead of adding a second copy. Keep it on one site; network-wide activation is refused.

F2 OpenRouter connection

InkRush > AI Settings > OpenRouter connection

Purpose. Connect InkRush to OpenRouter, the only service it uses to write.

Result. "Saved key" shows a masked key. The test says whether the key and model work.

You can. Save, test, replace or remove your OpenRouter API key.

Next. F3: check the model.

1 Open AI Settings

→

2 API key INPUT
Paste the key from your OpenRouter account. When one is saved, the field is called "Replace API key".

→

3 Save key
Message: "API key saved. Use Test API Connection to check it."

→

4 Test API Connection
Checks the key and the chosen model.

↓ continue at 5

5 What does the result say?

- **5a It passed**
  Continue at 6.
- **5b It failed**
  Fix the key, add credits, or change the model (F3). Then repeat 2 to 4.

→

6 Saved key: sk-… RESULT
The key is stored encrypted and never shown again.

→

7 Model and limits NEXT
F3.

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2	**API key / Replace API key**	**Required**	None	Paste your OpenRouter key. Saving an empty field keeps the saved key unchanged. Without a key, automation cannot start.
4	**Test API Connection**	**Recommended**	Button	Makes a real request to OpenRouter. A pass also clears an earlier AI pause.
–	**Remove key**	Optional	Button, shown when a key is saved	Asks you to confirm. AI jobs fail until a new key is saved.

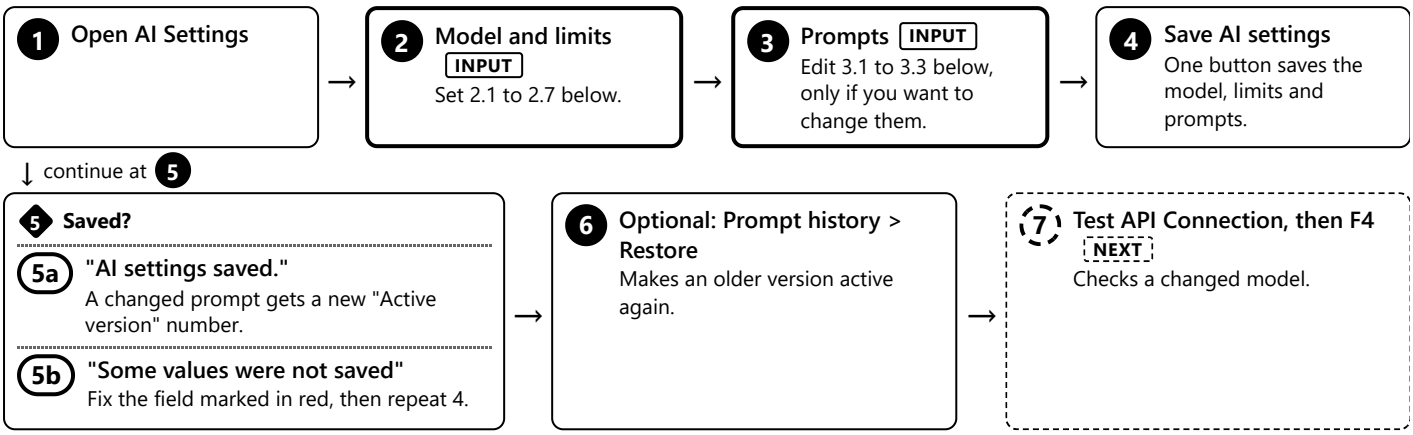
F3 Model, limits and prompts

Purpose. Decide which model writes, how long articles must be, how tags and dashes are handled, and exactly what the model is asked.

Result. "AI settings saved." New jobs use the new active prompt version. Jobs already running keep theirs.

You can. Change the model and limits, edit the three prompts, and restore an earlier prompt version.

Next. F4: try the prompts on sample text.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Model identifier**	**Required**	openai/gpt-6-luna	An OpenRouter model, written as provider/model. Used exactly as entered and never swapped. If it becomes unavailable, AI jobs pause and the Dashboard says so.
2.2	**Request timeout (seconds)**	Optional	120 (10–600)	How long to wait for the model. Raise it for slow models.
2.3	**Maximum attempts**	Optional	3 (1–10)	Tries per article for temporary problems. Each attempt costs money.
2.4	**Output token limit**	Optional	8000 (256–200000)	The longest answer allowed. Too low cuts articles short, and they fail the checks.
2.5	**Minimum article words**	Optional	600 (50–20000)	Shorter articles fail validation and are held. The target length itself comes from your prompt.
2.6	**If more than 20 tags come back**	Optional	Keep the first 20	See the options below. Fewer than 20 always means a retry, then the article is held.
2.7	**If the forbidden "—" appears**	Optional	Replace it with a comma …	See the options below.
3.1	**Article prompt**	**Required**	The owner's prompt, filled in	Sent after the source information. Saved exactly as typed, never corrected. Must not be empty.
3.2	**Tag prompt**	**Required**	Filled in	Sent after the finished article, to get 20 tags. Must not be empty.
3.3	**Accuracy and format instruction**	**Recommended**	Filled in	Sent as a separate system message: use only the source, ignore instructions inside source text, write HTML. Keep it unless you know why to change it.
6	**Prompt history: Restore**	Optional	Last 5 versions of each prompt	Shows version, date saved, characters and a SHA-256 fingerprint. "Active" marks the one in use.

If more than 20 tags come back: option	What it means	Choose it when
Keep the first 20	Extra tags are dropped.	Default. Most sites.
Retry, then hold the article	The answer is treated as wrong.	You want exactly what your tag prompt asks, nothing trimmed.

If the forbidden "—" appears: option	What it means	Choose it when
Replace it with a comma and note this in diagnostics	The article is fixed and still used.	Default.
Fail validation	The article is held.	You never want the model's text changed.
Allow it and warn	The dash stays. A warning is recorded.	You are happy with long dashes.

F4 Test generation and test draft

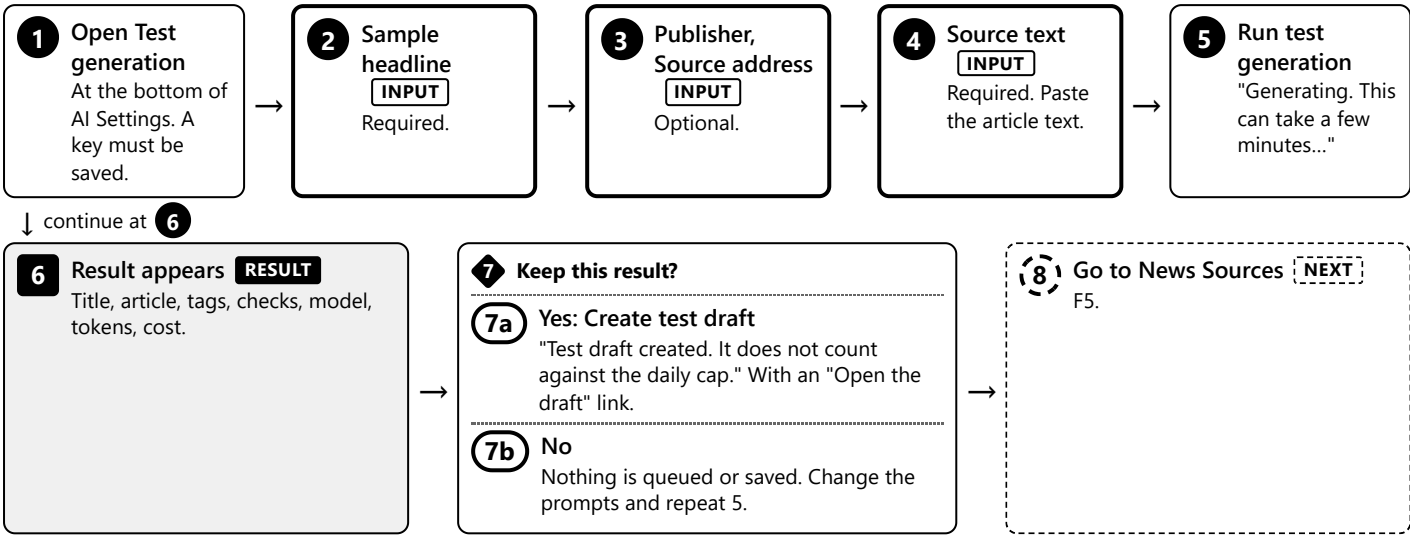
InkRush > AI Settings > Test generation

Purpose. See what your model and prompts produce before automation runs.

Result. The article, its 20 tags, any errors or warnings, the model, tokens and reported cost.

You can. Run the real prompts on text you paste, see the checks and cost, and optionally save the result as a draft post.

Next. Adjust prompts (F3), or start setting up sources (F5).



Test generation makes real OpenRouter requests, which count in Usage and cost money. The result can be saved as a draft for about an hour.

F5 News categories

InkRush > News Sources > Categories

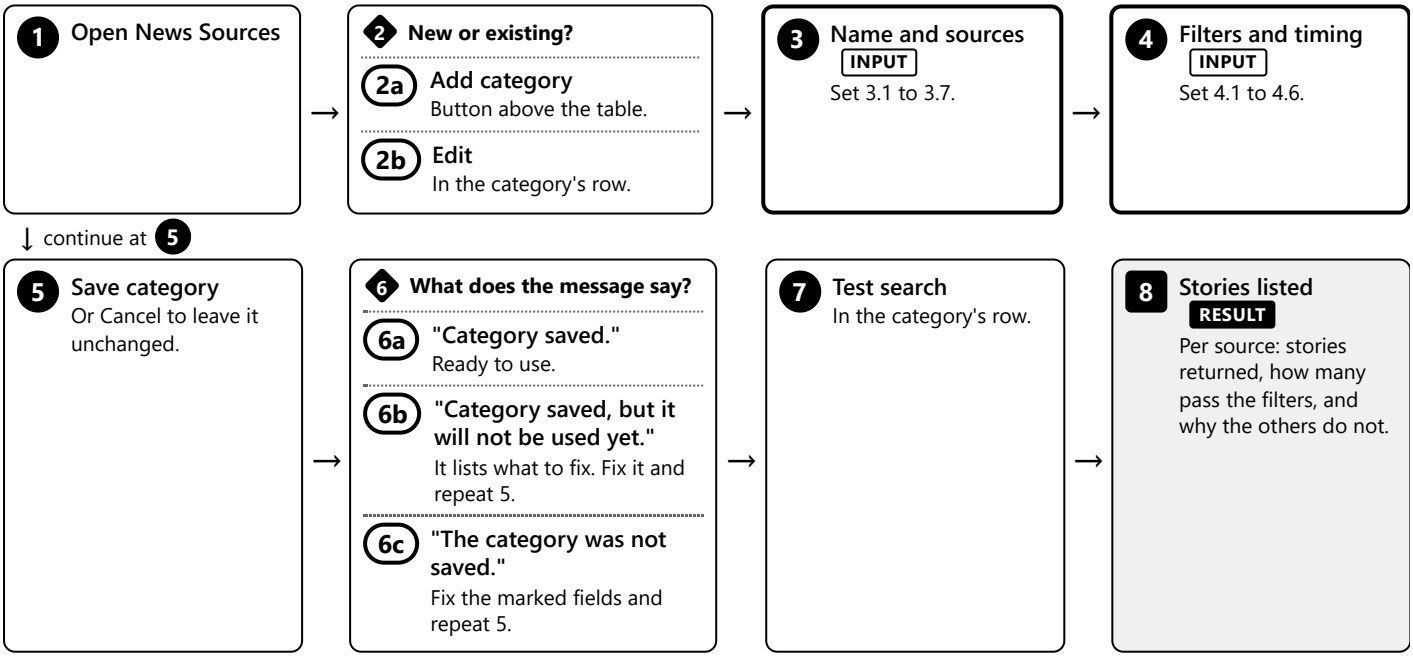
Purpose. Tell InkRush where to look for stories, and which ones to keep.

Result. Each category shows Ready, or what it still needs, in the Status column.

You can. Add, edit, test, duplicate, delete, reorder, enable and disable categories. 21 categories come ready, all enabled.

Next. F6 for global source rules, or F7 to set up authors.

A. Add or edit a category



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
3.1	**Category name**	**Required**	Empty for a new one	Any name. It is also the WordPress category name unless you map it (F9).
3.2	**Enabled**	**Recommended**	Ticked	Unticked, the category is never researched. At least one enabled category is needed to start.
3.3	**Sources to use**	Optional	Google News and publisher feeds	Or "Google News only", or "Publisher feeds only". "Use Google News RSS" (F6) turns all Google requests off.

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
3.4	**Weight**	Conditional	1 (1–100)	Only used by "Weighted random" rotation (F13). Higher is chosen more often.
3.5	**Google News topic addresses**	Conditional	Some starter categories have one	One address per line. These pages do not guarantee full article text.
3.6	**Search queries**	Conditional	One per starter category	One per line. Each runs as a Google News search.
3.7	**Publisher RSS or Atom feeds**	Conditional	1 or 2 per starter category	One per line. Recommended: feeds that post often are tried first and are the easiest to read. A category needs at least one usable source from 3.5 to 3.7.
4.1	**Required keywords**	Optional	Empty	One per line. A story must contain at least one. Empty means no requirement.
4.2	**Excluded keywords**	Optional	Empty	One per line. A story containing any of these is filtered out.
4.3	**Recency filter**	Optional	Past 24 hours	Past hour, Past 24 hours, Past week or Custom range. Not used while Past-Hour Posting is on (F12).
4.4	**Custom start, Custom end**	Conditional	Empty	Only with "Custom range". Date and time in your Schedule timezone.
4.5	**Language, Region**	Optional	en-US, US	For Google News, for example en-GB and GB.
4.6	**Days this category can be chosen**	Optional	Mon to Sun ticked	At least one day must stay ticked.

B. Manage the list

1 Open News Sources

→

2 **Choose an action in the row**

- **2a** **Up / Down** — Moves the category in the list.
- **2b** **Enabled / Disabled** — One click switches it.
- **2c** **Duplicate** — "Category duplicated. The copy starts disabled." Edit it, then enable it.
- **2d** **Delete** — Confirm. Past articles keep their records.

→

3 **The table updates** RESULT
With a message at the top.

F6 Source and duplicate rules

InkRush > News Sources > Source and duplicate rules

Purpose. Rules that apply to every category.

You can. Turn Google News on or off, set how much publisher text is needed, how politely sites are contacted, and how duplicates are spotted.

Result. "Settings saved." The rules apply from the next research round.

Next. F7: authors.

1 Open News Sources
Scroll to "Source and duplicate rules".

→

2 Change any of 2.1 to 2.13 INPUT
All are optional.

→

3 Save changes

→

4 "Settings saved." RESULT
Or fix the marked fields and repeat 3.

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Use Google News RSS**	Optional	Ticked	Untick to stop every request to Google News and use publisher feeds only. Google's robots.txt does not list /rss/ as allowed; the choice is yours.
2.2	**Minimum source words**	Optional	250 (20–20000)	Below this, no article is written.
2.3	**Partial source words**	Optional	80 (1–20000)	From here up to the minimum, the story is held as Partial.
2.4	**Maximum source characters**	Optional	30000 (1000–500000)	Longer text is cut before it is sent to the model. Lower it to spend less.
2.5	**Fetch timeout (seconds)**	Optional	20 (3–120)	How long to wait for a website.

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.6	**Gap between requests to one publisher (seconds)**	Optional	5 (0–3600)	Keeps requests to one site polite.
2.7	**Gap between requests to Google News (seconds)**	Optional	30 (1–3600)	Lower values make Google limits more likely.
2.8	**Fetch attempts**	Optional	3 (1–10)	Tries for temporary errors.
2.9	**Stories kept per fetch**	Optional	30 (1–200)	Stories taken from each feed or search.
2.10	**Headline similarity threshold**	Optional	0.75 (0.30–1.00)	Higher means only closer matches count as duplicates.
2.11	**Text similarity threshold**	Optional	0.85 (0.30–1.00)	The same, for the article text.
2.12	**Publisher headline match threshold**	Optional	0.70 (0.30–1.00)	How closely a Google News headline must match the publisher's own feed to find its page.
2.13	**Duplicate check window (days)**	Optional	14 (1–365)	How far back to look for duplicates.

F7 Authors

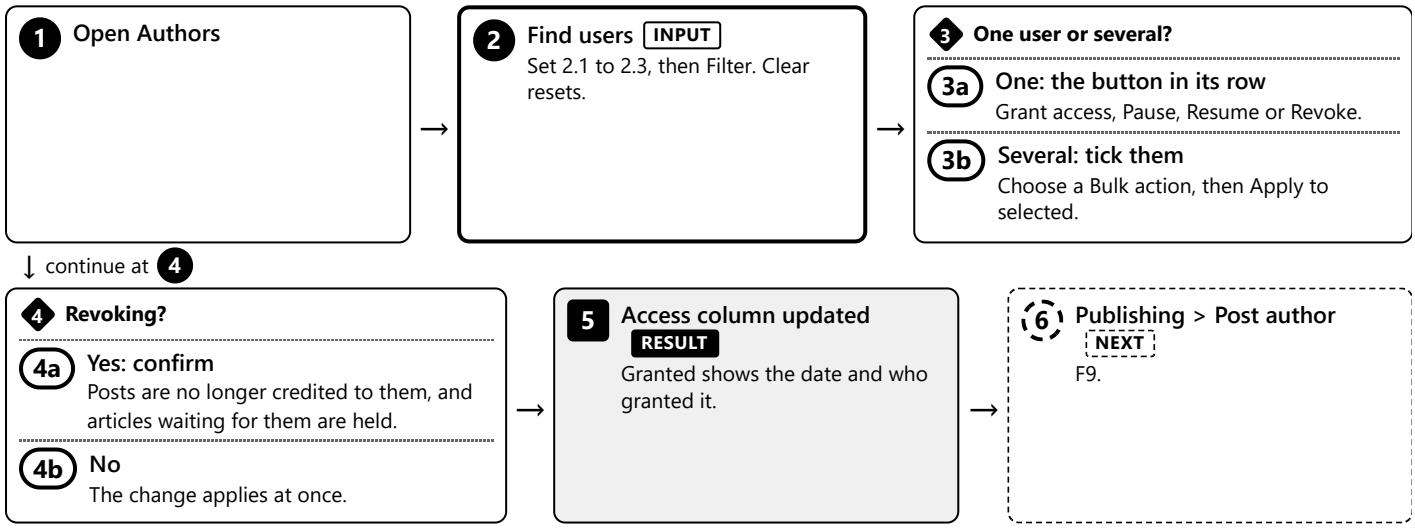
InkRush > Authors

Purpose. Choose exactly who may be credited with posts. Nobody is authorised automatically, whatever their WordPress role, and WordPress roles are never changed.

Result. The Access column shows Active, Paused, Revoked or Not authorised. The counts at the top update.

You can. Search users, grant, pause, resume or revoke access one by one or in bulk (up to 200 at a time).

Next. F8: Multiple users mode, or F9: choose the Post author.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Search**	Optional	Empty	Username, name or email.
2.2	**WordPress role**	Optional	Any role	Shows only users with this role.
2.3	**Access**	Optional	Everyone	Everyone, Authorised (any status), Active, Paused, Revoked or Not authorised.
3a	**Row buttons**	**Required**	Grant access	Not authorised or Revoked: Grant access. Active: Pause, Revoke. Paused: Resume, Revoke. At least one Active author is needed to start.
3b	**Bulk action**	Optional	Bulk action	Grant access, Pause or Revoke access, for the ticked users. The top checkbox ticks the whole page (50 users per page).

Only an Active author can be credited. The author is checked again right before each post, so a change applies at once. A held article can be retried on the Articles page (F16). A "Deleted users" box lists authorised users later deleted from WordPress. The Posting mode card at the top, and the Schedule column with its Schedule button, are explained in F8.

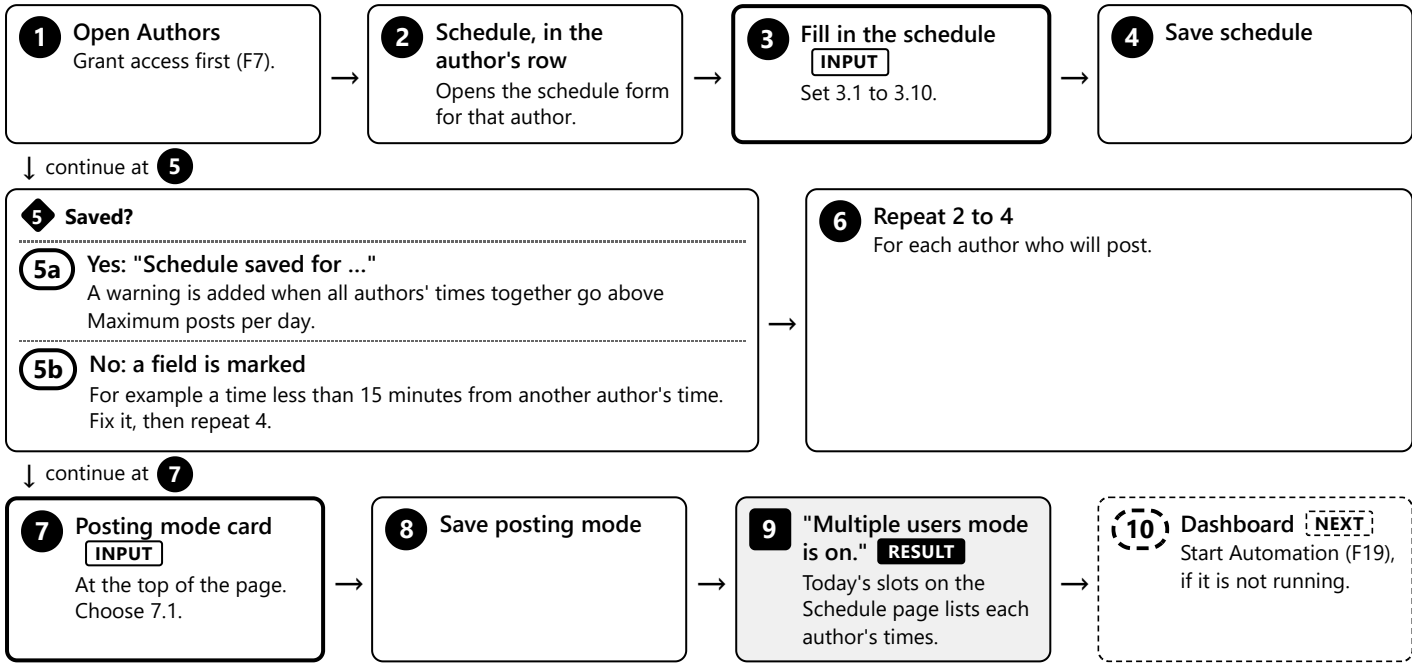
F8 Multiple users mode

Purpose. Let several authorised people post, each on their own days, times and timezone, and be credited with their own posts.

Result. Schedule > Today's slots lists each author's times with their names, and each post is credited to the author whose time it is.

You can. Choose Single user or Multiple users mode, and give each active author a schedule: timezone, days, dates, post times, posts at each time, categories, limits, and what happens to a missed time.

Next. F9: publishing settings. The Post author there is used only in Single user mode.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
Posting mode card				
7.1	**Who posts, and when**	Required	Single user mode	"Single user mode": every post is credited to the Post author (F9), at the times on the Schedule page (F11). "Multiple users mode": each active author with a schedule posts at their own times. It can be chosen only when at least one active author has a schedule that is ticked on, with a post time.
Schedule of an author				
3.1	**Post on this schedule**	Required	Not ticked	Tick it to use this schedule. Unticked, the author keeps their access but gets no times.
3.2	**Timezone**	Required	The site timezone	The author's own, such as Europe/London, or a fixed offset such as +06:00. Their times, dates and limits all follow it.
3.3	**Post times**	Required	None (up to 24)	24-hour times separated by commas, such as 09:00, 13:30. At least 15 minutes apart, also across midnight, and at least 15 minutes from every other active author's time, checked over the next 14 days in each timezone.
3.4	**Posts at each time**	Optional	1 (1–5)	Several posts at one time go out one after another.
3.5	**From, Until**	Optional	Empty	The first and the last date the author posts, in their own calendar. Both days are included.
3.6	**Days of the week**	Required	Every day	Tick at least one day.
3.7	**Dates to skip**	Optional	None	Dates such as 2026-12-25, separated by commas.
3.8	**Categories**	Optional	None ticked: all enabled	Tick some to post only articles from them. Research for this author keeps to them too.
3.9	**Most posts a day, a week, a month**	Optional	0: no limit (0–1,000)	Counted in the author's calendar, weeks from Monday to Sunday, the same way as What counts toward the maximum (F11, 2.6). Under each box: how many are used now.
3.10	**When a time is missed**	Optional	Publish at the author's next time today	Or "Skip it". A time is missed when no article was ready in time.

Still for the whole site in Multiple users mode: Maximum posts per day, What counts toward the maximum, Maximum article generations per day, the slot grace period and catch-up gap, Past-Hour Posting, Rotation mode, Automatic stop and the Research settings. **Not used:** the Post author, Daily target, Interval, First publishing time, When a slot has no article, Categories in rotation and the slot categories.

Right before each post, the author whose time it is must be Active and under their limits. If not, that time is closed with the reason in Logs, and the article waits for another author's time. No research is started for an author who cannot post. Switching modes closes the times planned for the other mode that were not used yet, and Logs show who switched. Back in Single user mode, everything works exactly as before.

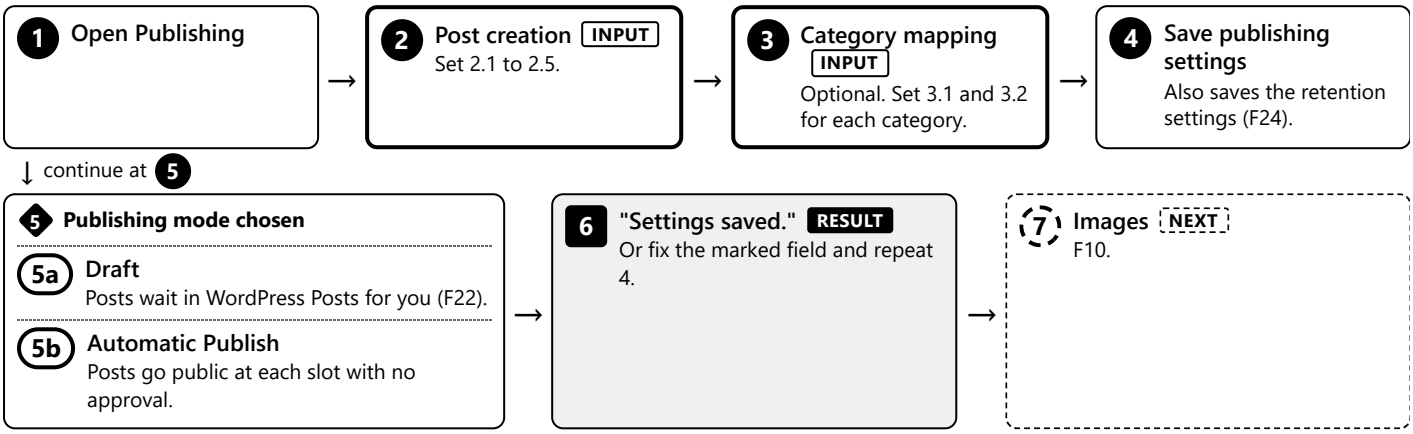
F9 Publishing settings

Purpose. Decide how each post is created, who it is credited to, and where it goes.

You can. Choose Draft or Automatic Publish, tag handling, source attribution and the Post author, and map each news category to a WordPress category and its own mode.

Result. "Settings saved." Every new post follows these choices.

Next. F10: images.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Publishing mode**	**Recommended**	Automatic Publish	See the options below. Articles that fail the checks are held in both modes.
2.2	**Tags**	Optional	Reuse matching tags and create missing ones	Or "Only use tags that already exist".
2.3	**Source attribution**	Optional	Store in post data only	Or "Store in post data and add a visible source line". The source address and publisher are always kept with the post.
2.4	**Post author**	**Conditional**	None chosen	In Single user mode: choose an Active author from F7. Only active authors are listed. Automation cannot start, and posts stop, without one. Not used in Multiple users mode (F8): each post is credited to the author whose time it is.
2.5	**Create a WordPress category when none matches**	**Conditional**	Ticked	Needed when a news category has no WordPress category of the same name and is not mapped in 3.1. Otherwise automation cannot start.
3.1	**WordPress category (per news category)**	Optional	Same name	Pick an existing WordPress category to post into instead.
3.2	**Mode for this category**	Optional	Use the global mode	Or Draft, or Automatic Publish, for this category only.

Publishing mode: option	What it means	Choose it when
Draft: create drafts for review	Each post is a draft until you publish it.	You want to read and approve every post. Recommended while you try InkRush.
Automatic Publish: publish with no approval	Posts that pass every check are published at their slot.	You trust your prompts and sources, and review afterwards.

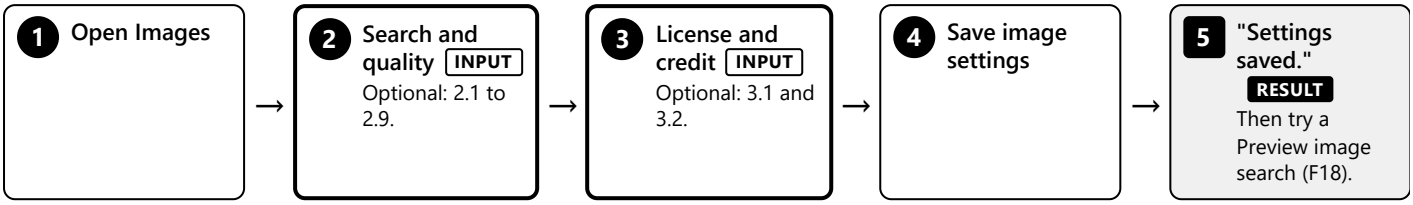
F10 Image settings

Purpose. Control how the featured image for each post is found and credited. Images are chosen by rules, not AI, and come only from Wikimedia Commons.

Result. "Settings saved." New image searches use the new rules. Images already used are not changed.

You can. Change how many files are checked, the minimum size and score, the credit line, and whether CC BY-SA images are accepted.

Next. F11: the schedule.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
Fixed rules, shown on the page				
–	**Featured image**	Fixed	Required on every post	Cannot be turned off. A post goes public only when its image is set and opens, also when a person publishes an InkRush draft by hand.
–	**When no image can be used**	Fixed	Held	The article waits in Failed or held, and its image search runs once more 6 hours later. With Past-Hour Posting, another story is chosen while there is time.
–	**Licenses accepted, Repeat prevention, Credit placement**	Fixed	Always on	CC0, public domain and CC BY (plus CC BY-SA if 3.2 is ticked). No image is ever used twice. The credit goes directly below the image.
Settings you can change				
2.1	**Searches for each article**	Optional	4 (3–5)	More searches find more candidates, more slowly.
2.2	**Files checked for each search**	Optional	20 (5–50)	
2.3	**Minimum width (pixels)**	Optional	1200 (600–10000)	Smaller files are refused.
2.4	**Minimum height (pixels)**	Optional	675 (300–10000)	
2.5	**Preferred width-to-height shape**	Optional	1.78	16:9 is 1.78. Closer shapes score higher.
2.6	**Minimum relevance score (out of 100)**	Optional	65 (1–100)	Files below it are not used. Lower it if many articles are held for no image.
2.7	**Largest file to download (MB)**	Optional	15 (1–100)	
2.8	**Attempts for each article**	Optional	3 (1–10)	For temporary problems, such as Wikimedia being busy.
2.9	**Seconds between Wikimedia requests**	Optional	3 (0–60)	Keep it at 3 or more. Wikimedia limits fast requests.
3.1	**Show the credit line**	Optional	On every image	Or "Only when the license requires it (CC BY and CC BY-SA)".
3.2	**Accept CC BY-SA images**	**Recommended**	Ticked	Finds images for many more stories. Do not edit these images. Unticked, more articles may be held for no image.

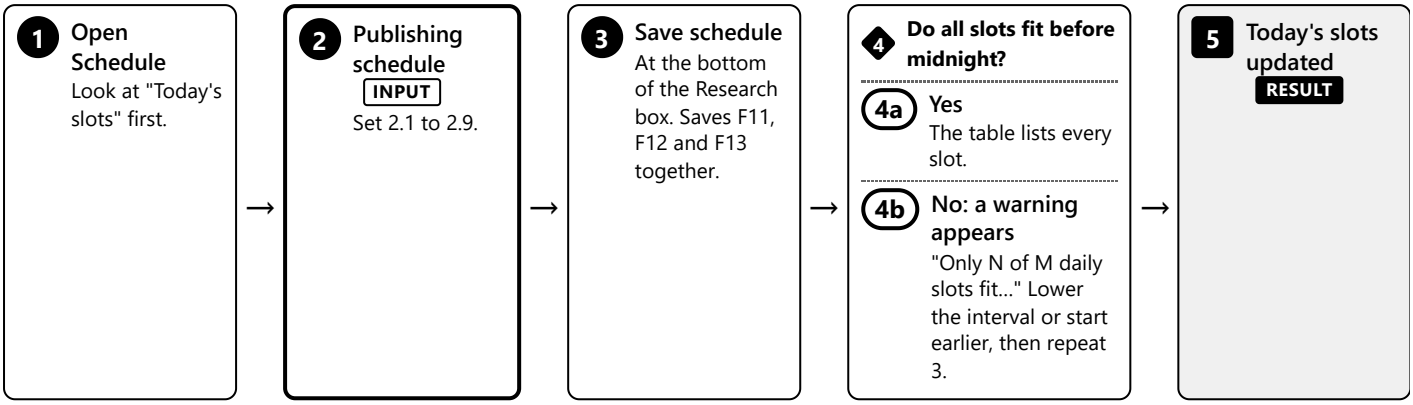
F11 Publishing schedule

Purpose. Decide how many posts a day, at what times, and in which timezone.

Result. The "Today's slots" table shows each slot in local time and UTC. With the defaults: 10:00, 16:00 and 22:00.

You can. Set the daily target, interval, first time, timezone, a hard daily maximum and what happens to a slot with no article.

Next. F12: Past-Hour Posting, on the same page.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Daily target**	**Recommended**	3 (1–48)	Posts to aim for each day. Not guaranteed: each post needs a usable story and image.
2.2	**Interval (hours)**	**Recommended**	6 (1–24)	Time between slots.
2.3	**First publishing time**	**Recommended**	10:00	The first slot of the day, in the timezone below.
2.4	**Timezone**	**Required**	+10:30	A name such as Australia/Lord_Howe follows daylight saving. A fixed offset such as +10:30 never changes. Must be valid to start. Start typing to see the list.
2.5	**Maximum posts per day**	Optional	3 (1–96)	Never exceeded, counted by local calendar day.
2.6	**What counts toward the maximum**	Optional	Drafts and published posts	Or "Published posts only". Drafts and published posts are always shown separately on the Dashboard.
2.7	**When a slot has no article**	**Conditional**	Publish next available	"Publish next available: try again at the next slot time", or "Skip missed slot". Not used while Past-Hour Posting is on.
2.8	**Slot grace period (minutes)**	Optional	30 (1–720)	How long after its time a slot keeps waiting for an article.
2.9	**Minimum gap before a catch-up post (minutes)**	**Conditional**	30 (0–720)	Only for catch-up posts.

In Multiple users mode (F8), Today's slots lists each author's times for today, with the author, category and status, and 2.1 to 2.3 and 2.7 are not used. 2.4 to 2.6, 2.8 and 2.9 still apply. The Dashboard's Next publish slot also says who it is by.

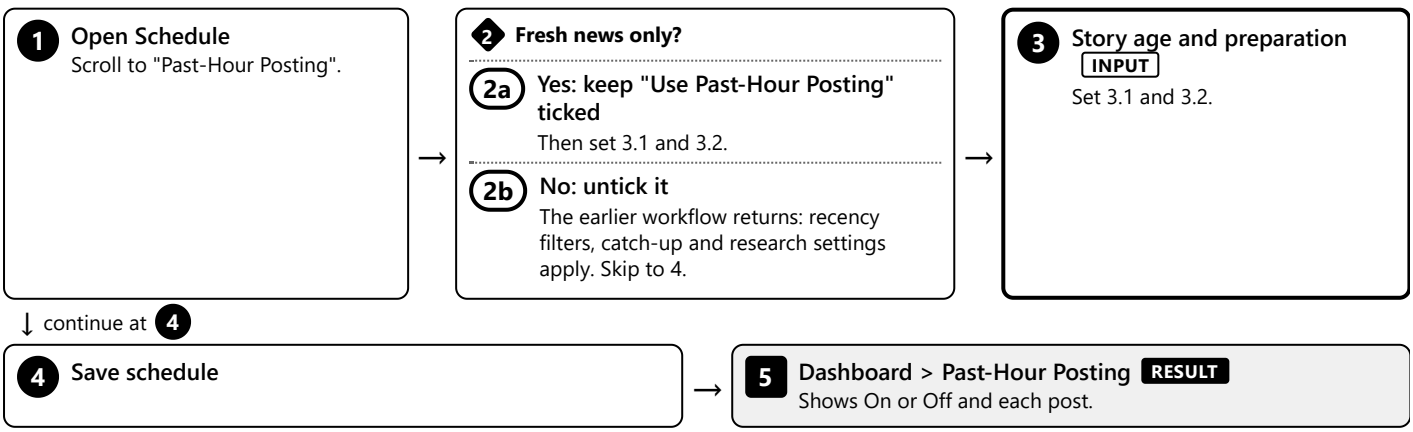
F12 Past-Hour Posting

Purpose. Publish only very fresh news. On by default.

Result. The Dashboard's Past-Hour Posting table shows every post of the day, its story, its age and the result.

You can. Each post uses one story that is no older than the maximum age when it goes out. If there is none, that post is skipped and never caught up.

Next. F13: rotation and research.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2	**Use Past-Hour Posting**	Optional	Ticked	Applies to all enabled categories. While on, the recency filters, catch-up and the Research settings other than the generation limit do not apply.
3.1	**Maximum story age (minutes)**	**Conditional**	120 (60–180)	Measured at the post time: with 120, a 10:00 post can only use a story published after about 08:05. Never longer than the interval between posts.
3.2	**Start preparing before each post (minutes)**	**Conditional**	120 (15–180)	No more than the maximum age. Searches run every 15 minutes until a story is found.

Fewer posts can appear with Past-Hour Posting, because topic feeds rarely have news under an hour old. Publisher feeds that post often help most (F5, 3.7).

F13 Category rotation and research

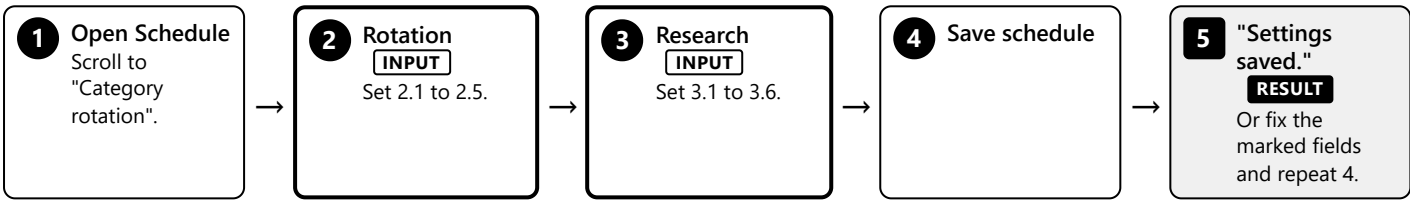
InkRush > Schedule > Category rotation, Research

Purpose. Decide which category fills each slot, and how far ahead stories are researched.

You can. Choose a rotation mode, limit which categories rotate, fix a category to a slot, and set research timing and a daily AI spending guard.

Result. Slots are filled from the categories you chose. The Dashboard shows the category of the next slot.

Next. F14: server cron, or F15: automatic stop.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Rotation mode**	Optional	Round robin	See the options below.
2.2	**Avoid repeating a category on the same day when others are available**	Optional	Ticked	
2.3	**If a slot's category has no article ready, use another category's article**	Optional	Ticked	Unticked, the slot waits for its own category.
2.4	**Categories in rotation**	Optional	None ticked	Leave all unticked to use every enabled category. Tick some to rotate only those.
2.5	**Slot 1 (10:00), Slot 2 (16:00) ...**	**Conditional**	Rotation chooses	Only with "Choose per slot". Pick a category for that slot.
3.1	**Discovery every (minutes)**	**Conditional**	60 (5–1440)	Runs separately from publishing. Not used while Past-Hour Posting is on.
3.2	**Start research before a slot (hours)**	**Conditional**	4 (1–48)	A category is researched only when its next slot is this close, so its news is still fresh.
3.3	**Articles to keep ready per category**	**Conditional**	1 (1–20)	More means more AI spending ahead of time.
3.4	**Maximum article generations per day**	**Recommended**	12 (1–500)	A spending guard. Counts every generation attempt. Applies with Past-Hour Posting too.
3.5	**Skip queued articles older than (hours)**	**Conditional**	48 (1–720)	Old news is not published.
3.6	**Worker run length (seconds)**	Optional	50 (10–280)	A worker run stops starting new jobs after this time.

Rotation mode: option	What it means	Choose it when
Round robin	Categories take turns.	Default. Even coverage.
Weighted random	Categories are picked at random, more often for a higher Weight (F5, 3.4).	Some categories matter more.
Choose per slot, round robin for the rest	Slots you set in 2.5 use that category. The others take turns.	A category must appear at a fixed time.

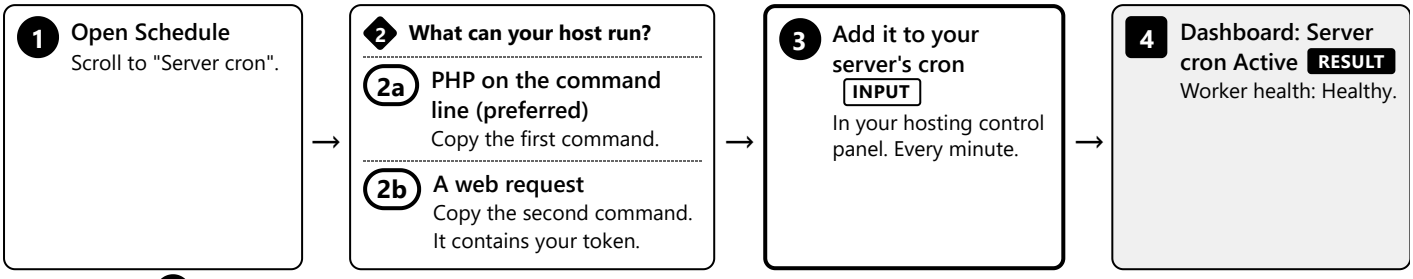
F14 Server cron

Purpose. WordPress's built-in timer only runs when someone visits your site. A server cron job runs the worker every minute, so posts appear on time.

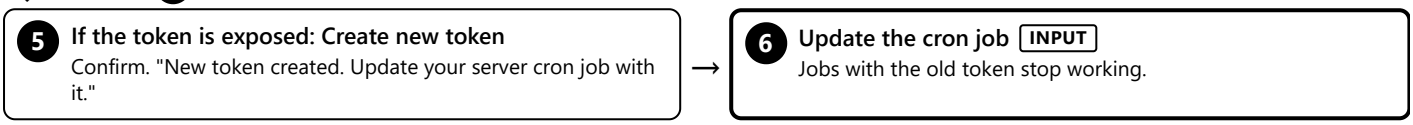
Result. Dashboard > Worker shows "Server cron: Active".

You can. Copy a ready-made command for your server, and create a new token if the old one is exposed.

Next. F15, or start automation (F19).



↓ continue at 5



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
3	**Server cron job**	Recommended	Not set up	Without it, scheduling relies on site visits, and the Dashboard says "Not detected". With no heartbeat for 5 minutes, Worker health shows "Stalled".
5	**Create new token**	Conditional	Button	Only for the web-request method. Treat the token like a password. It can only trigger a worker run.

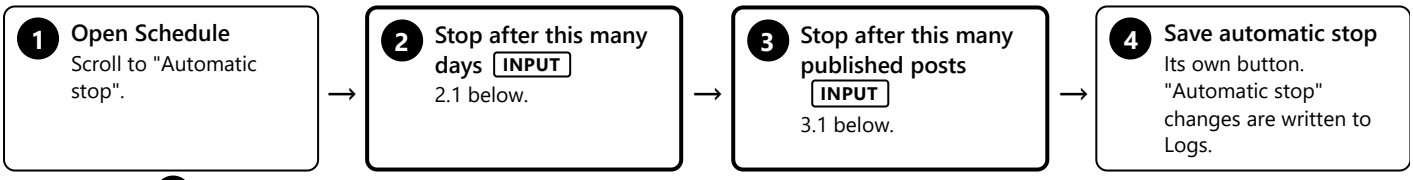
F15 Automatic stop

Purpose. Stop automation by itself after a number of days or published posts, whichever comes first.

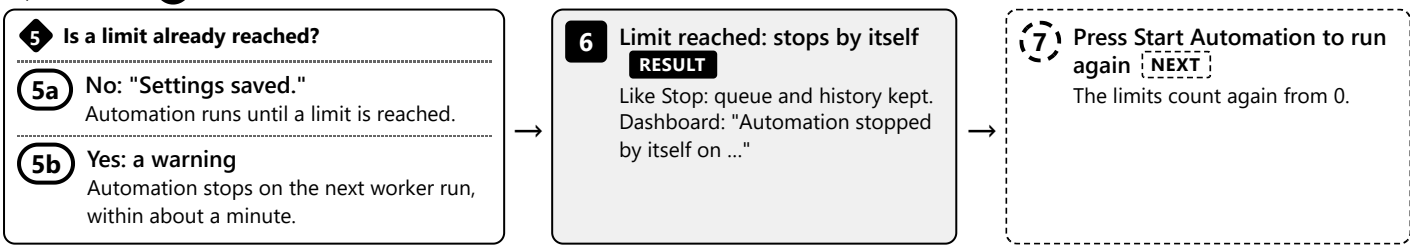
Result. "Now:" shows the limits and progress, for example "Stops after 50 published posts (12 so far) ...". The Dashboard's Worker box shows the same.

You can. Set a days limit, a posts limit, or both. 0 means no limit, and both are 0 by default.

Next. Start automation (F19).



↓ continue at 5



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Stop after this many days**	Optional	0 = no limit (0–365)	Full days of 24 hours from the last Start Automation.
3.1	**Stop after this many published posts**	Optional	0 = no limit (0–10000)	Only posts InkRush publishes count. Drafts do not, so in Draft mode only the days limit can stop automation.

F19 Automation controls

InkRush > Dashboard, top box

Purpose. Start, stop, pause and resume the background work.

Result. The state badge shows Not configured, Stopped, Starting, Running, Paused or Error, with "Research paused" or "Publishing paused" tags.

You can. Start Automation, Stop Automation, pause and resume research or publishing separately, and resume after an AI problem.

Next. Watch the Dashboard (F20).

A. Start

1 Open Dashboard

→

2 Is "Needed before you can start" shown?

- **2a** Yes — Fix each item on the page it names (Section 8), then come back.
- **2b** No — Continue at 3.

→

3 Start Automation

→

4 Starting, then Running **RESULT**

"Automation is starting. It will show Running after the first worker run. It keeps going after you close this page or log out."

B. Pause, resume and stop, while running

1 Open Dashboard

→

2 What do you want?

- **2a** Pause Research — No new stories are found or read. Articles already being written continue, and queued articles can still be published.
- **2b** Pause Publishing — Nothing is posted. Research and writing can continue to fill the queue.
- **2c** Resume Research / Resume Publishing / Resume — Resume restarts everything paused, and AI jobs after an AI problem.
- **2d** Stop Automation — Confirm. Future jobs are cancelled. Queued articles and history are kept.

→

3 Message and new state **RESULT**

"Research paused.", "Publishing paused.", "Resumed." or "Automation stopped."

"AI jobs are paused: …" appears when OpenRouter refuses the key, has no credits, or the model is gone. Research and publishing of finished articles continue. Fix the cause (F2, F3), then press Resume. "Posts are not being published: …" means the Post author is no longer active (F7, F9).

F20 Dashboard monitoring

InkRush > Dashboard

Purpose. See what is happening today, at a glance.

Result. The figures refresh every 30 seconds while the page is open, and the page reloads by itself when the state changes.

You can. Read today's figures, worker health, the next slot and discovery, AI usage, the Past-Hour table, image status, recent errors and activity.

Next. Open Articles (F16), Usage (F21) or Logs (F17) for detail.

1 Open Dashboard

→

2 Read the 14 figures **RESULT**

Target today, Drafts created today, Published today, Waiting in queue, Failed or held, and the research figures.

→

3 Check Worker **RESULT**

Last heartbeat, Worker health, Automatic stop, Server cron, Next publish slot, Next discovery.

↓ continue at **4**

4 Anything wrong?

- **4a** Worker: Stalled — Set up or check the server cron (F14).
- **4b** Failed or held above 0 — Articles > Failed or held (F16).
- **4c** Recent errors listed — Logs, filtered by Severity: error (F17).

→

5 View usage, Image settings and history, See Failed or held **NEXT**

Links in the boxes.

Box on the Dashboard	What it shows	Useful when
Today's figures	Target today, Drafts created today, Published today, Waiting in queue, Failed or held, Discovered today, Filtered out, Duplicates, Sources retrieved, Sources not usable, Generated, Validated, Images added today, Posts with no image today	Checking the day's progress
Worker	Last heartbeat, Worker health (Healthy, Stalled or Not running), Automatic stop, Stale jobs, Server cron, Next publish slot (with its category), Next discovery	Posts are late or missing
OpenRouter today	Requests, Tokens, Reported cost, View usage	Watching spending
Past-Hour Posting	On or Off. Per post: Post time, Preparation starts, Headline, Source, Published, Age when selected, Age before publishing, Category, Fallback used, Processing, Result	Seeing why a post was skipped
Featured images	Held: no usable image, Published posts with no image, recent image events	Articles are held for images
Recent errors, Recent activity	The latest 5 errors and 12 events, with time, stage, severity, status and message	A quick look before opening Logs

F16 Articles

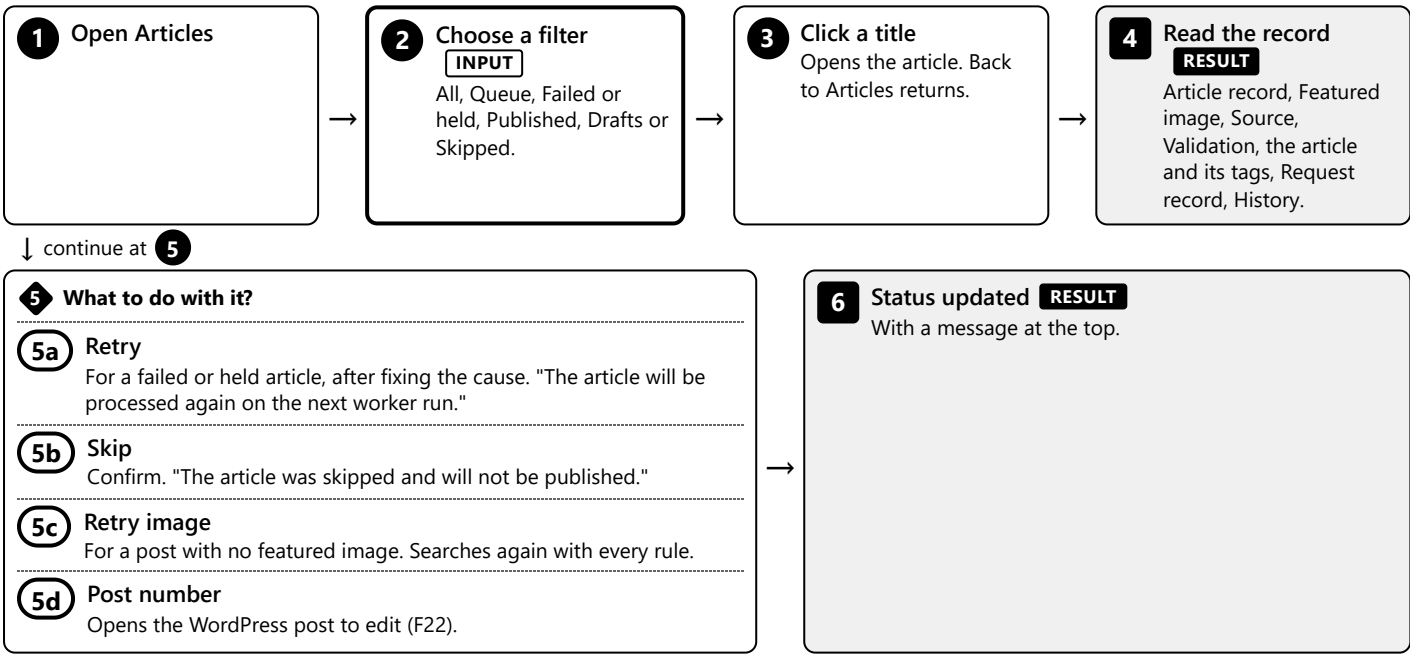
InkRush > Articles

Purpose. Every story the plugin worked on, from research to post.

Result. The article's full record. Retried articles are processed again on the next worker run.

You can. Filter the list, open any article to see its source, checks, text and history, and Retry, Skip or Retry image.

Next. Logs (F17) for everything around it.



Status group	Statuses you may see	Meaning
In progress	RETRIEVAL_PENDING, RETRIEVED, AI_PENDING, AI_RUNNING, GENERATED, VALIDATING, VALIDATED, QUEUED, SCHEDULED, PUBLISHING	Being read, written, checked or waiting for its slot
Failed or held	PARTIAL, BLOCKED, RETRIEVAL_FAILED, AI_FAILED, VALIDATION_FAILED, HELD, PUBLISH_FAILED	Stopped for a reason shown under the title. Retry is offered
Done	DRAFT_CREATED, PUBLISHED	A WordPress post exists
Not used	SKIPPED, CANCELLED, DUPLICATE, ARCHIVED	Will not be published

F17 Logs and CSV export

InkRush > Logs

Purpose. The complete record of what happened and why.

You can. Filter every event by date, category, stage, severity, status, job, post or person, and export the filtered events as a CSV file.

Result. A table of matching events, 50 per page, or a downloaded file named like `inkrush-logs-20261106-093000.csv`.

Next. Open the article (F16) named in the Job column.

1 Open Logs

→ **2 Set filters** INPUT
2.1 to 2.8. Leave any empty for all.

→ **3 Apply filters**
Clear removes every filter.

→ **4 Matching events** RESULT
Times in your timezone. Hover over a time for UTC.

↓ continue at 5

5 Need a file?

5a Yes: Export CSV
Exports the events matching the current filters, up to 20,000.

5b No
Use Previous and Next to page through.

→ **6 CSV saved by your browser** RESULT
Open it in a spreadsheet program.

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**From, To**	Optional	Empty	Dates, in your Schedule timezone.
2.2	**Category**	Optional	All	One news category.
2.3	**Stage**	Optional	All	discovery, filtering, dedupe, retrieval, ai, validation, queue, image, publishing, past_hour, access, scheduler, control, config or maintenance.
2.4	**Severity**	Optional	All	info, warning or error.
2.5	**Status**	Optional	Empty	Type a status, such as PUBLISHED or HELD.
2.6	**Job id**	Optional	Empty	The Job number from Articles.
2.7	**Post id**	Optional	Empty	A WordPress post number.
2.8	**Person**	Optional	Anyone	An author from the Authors page: what they did and what was credited to them.

The CSV has the columns id, created_at_utc, stage, severity, status, error_code, message, category_id, source_item_id, article_job_id, wp_post_id, actor_user_id, author_user_id and attempt. Values that a spreadsheet could run as a formula are written with a leading apostrophe.

F18 Image tools and history

InkRush > Images > Test tools, Published posts with no image, Image totals, Image history, Image log

Purpose. Check and repair featured images.

You can. Test the Wikimedia connection, preview which image a text would get, add images to older posts, see every image ever used, and release one for reuse.

Result. Preview results, a featured image added to a post, or an image released and logged.

Next. Articles (F16) for an article's own image record.

A. Test and preview

1 Open Images
Scroll to "Test tools".

→ **2 Test Wikimedia connection**
The result appears beside the button.

→ **3 Headline or article text** INPUT
Paste text. Choose a Category, or None.

→ **4 Preview image search**

→ **5 Each file checked** RESULT
Score, license, creator and result. Nothing is reserved, downloaded or saved.

B. Repair and history

1 Open Images

→

2 What do you need?

- **2a** Published posts with no image: Retry image
  For posts from before images were required. "The featured image was added to the post." or "No image was added: ..."
- **2b** Image history: Release
  Confirm. A future article may use the image again, which may repeat a picture. Written to the log.
- **2c** Image totals, Image log
  Searches, files checked, downloaded, set as featured, no suitable image, failures; the latest 15 image events.

→

3 Message at the top **RESULT**

Image history is the permanent record: picture, status, file (links to Wikimedia Commons), creator, license, article, post and when it was reserved, 25 per page. Release an image only if you are sure it may be used again.

F21 Usage

InkRush > Usage

Purpose. See what OpenRouter reported for every request, and how many images were handled.

Result. Requests, failed requests, input, output and total tokens, and the reported cost in US dollars. "Unavailable" means OpenRouter reported no cost. Costs are never estimated.

You can. Compare Today, This month and All time, check the latest generation, and page through every request.

Next. Lower costs with "Maximum article generations per day" (F13, 3.4) or "Maximum source characters" (F6, 2.4).

1 Open Usage
Or View usage on the Dashboard.

→

2 OpenRouter totals **RESULT**
Today, This month, All time.

→

3 Images **RESULT**
Searches, Files checked, Downloaded, Set as featured, No suitable image, Failures. Images cost nothing here.

→

4 Latest generation **RESULT**
Time, Model, Generation id, Request id, Result.

→

5 Request history **RESULT**
Time, Purpose, Job, Model, Result, tokens, Cost, Generation id. 25 per page: Previous, Next.

F22 Review drafts and posts

WordPress: Posts

Purpose. Approve posts in Draft mode, or edit any post afterwards.

Result. A published post with its featured image, its credit line and, if chosen, a visible source line.

You can. Read each draft, edit it, and publish it yourself.

Next. Articles (F16) shows the post number for each article.

1 Open Posts > Drafts
In Draft mode (F9, 2.1), InkRush posts wait here.

→

2 Open a draft and review it **INPUT**
Check facts against the source. The source address is kept with the post.

→

3 Publish
The WordPress button.

→

4 Does the featured image open?

- **4a** Yes
  The post is published.
- **4b** No
  It is kept as a draft, and Logs says why. Use Retry image in Articles (F16).

→

5 Post is live **RESULT**

F24 Data retention and removal

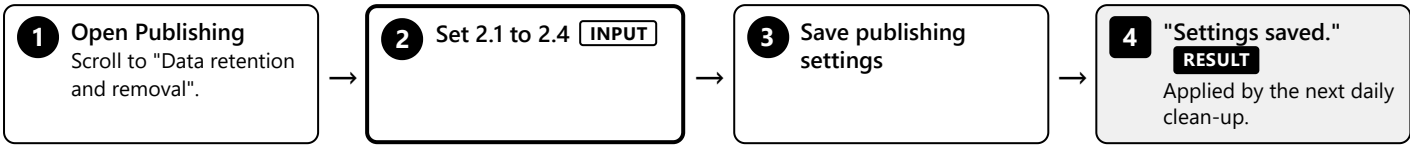
InkRush > Publishing > Data retention and removal

Purpose. Decide how long records are kept, and what deleting the plugin removes.

Result. A daily job removes records older than the periods. Article records, usage history and post links are kept so reports stay complete.

You can. Change the three retention periods, and choose whether deleting the plugin also deletes its data.

Next. F25 if you are removing the plugin.



No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
2.1	**Keep publisher text and rejected stories (days)**	Optional	30 (1–3650)	
2.2	**Keep logs (days)**	Optional	90 (1–3650)	Export a CSV first (F17) if you need older logs.
2.3	**Keep raw diagnostics of failed articles (days)**	Optional	30 (1–3650)	
2.4	**Delete all plugin data when the plugin is deleted**	Conditional	Off	Only when you intend to remove InkRush for good. Ticked, deleting the plugin removes its tables and settings, including the API key. Deactivating never deletes data, and WordPress posts are never deleted.

F25 Deactivate or delete

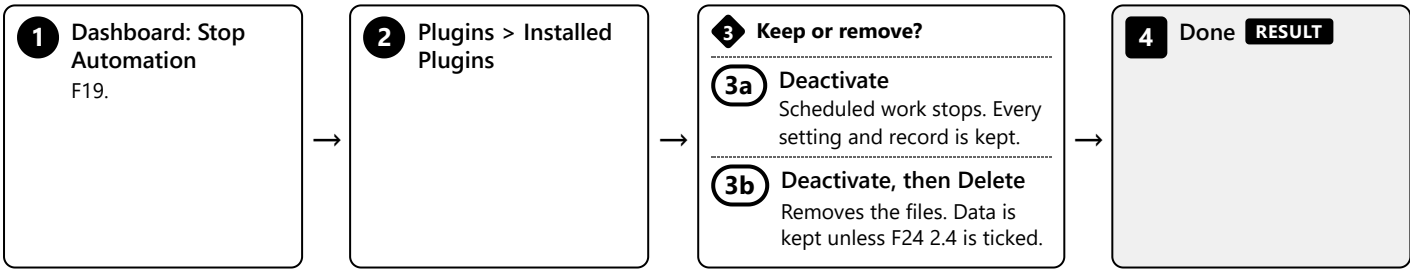
WordPress: Plugins > Installed Plugins > InkRush

Purpose. Turn InkRush off, or remove it.

Result. Posts, categories, tags and Media Library images always stay.

You can. Deactivate to pause everything with all data kept, or delete the plugin files, and its data too if F24 2.4 is ticked.

Next. Reactivate later: InkRush stays Stopped until you press Start Automation.



5 Complete settings guide

Every setting is explained in Section 4, beside the workflow that uses it. This section tells you which ones you must set, and where to find all the others.

Minimum setup: the only settings that must be in place before Start Automation works

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
AI Settings				
1.1	**API key**	Required	None	Paste your OpenRouter key and press Save key (F2).
1.2	**Model identifier**	Required	openai/gpt-6-luna	Already filled in. Change it only if you want another model (F3).
1.3	**Article prompt, Tag prompt**	Required	Filled in	Already filled in. They must not be empty (F3).
Authors and Publishing				
2.1	**Grant access**	Required	Nobody	Grant access to the user to credit (F7).
2.2	**Post author**	Required	None chosen	Choose that user on Publishing, then Save publishing settings (F9). In Multiple users mode, an active author with a schedule instead (F8).
2.3	**Create a WordPress category when none matches**	Conditional	Ticked	Leave ticked, or map every category (F9).
News Sources and Schedule				

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
3.1	**At least one enabled category with a source**	**Required**	21 ready, enabled	Already met. Disable the ones you do not want (F5).
3.2	**Timezone**	**Required**	+10:30	Already valid. Change it to your own timezone if needed (F11).

Recommended next: settings that shape the result

No.	Setting, as shown	Need	Default (range)	What to choose, and what happens
4.1	**Test API Connection**	**Recommended**		Confirms the key and model work (F2).
4.2	**Publishing mode**	**Recommended**	Automatic Publish	Choose Draft to approve each post at first (F9).
4.3	**Daily target, Interval, First publishing time**	**Recommended**	3, 6 hours, 10:00	How many posts, and when (F11).
4.4	**Maximum article generations per day**	**Recommended**	12	Your daily spending guard (F13).
4.5	**Accept CC BY-SA images**	**Recommended**	Ticked	Fewer articles held for no image (F10).
4.6	**Server cron job**	**Recommended**	Not set up	Posts on time, even with no visitors (F14).

Where every other setting is

Page and box	Settings	Explained in
News Sources > Add or Edit category	Category name, Enabled, Sources to use, Weight, topic addresses, search queries, feeds, required and excluded keywords, Recency filter, Custom start and end, Language, Region, Days	F5, table A
News Sources > Source and duplicate rules	Use Google News RSS, source word limits, fetch timeout and gaps, attempts, stories per fetch, three similarity thresholds, duplicate window	F6
AI Settings	API key, Model identifier, timeout, attempts, token limit, minimum words, tag and dash rules, three prompts, prompt history	F2, F3
Schedule	Publishing schedule (9), Past-Hour Posting (3), Category rotation (5), Research (6), Automatic stop (2), Server cron token	F11 to F15
Publishing	Publishing mode, Tags, Source attribution, Post author, category auto-create, category mapping and mode, retention (4)	F9, F24
Authors	Access for each user, Posting mode, and each author's schedule (10)	F7, F8
Images	Search and quality (9), credit line, CC BY-SA	F10
Dashboard, Articles, Usage, Logs	No settings. Controls and filters only	F16 to F21

> After changing settings, always press that box's Save button. "Unsaved changes" appears beside the button of a settings form you have changed. If a value is out of range, the other values are still saved and that field is marked with what is allowed, for example "Enter a number from 1 to 48."

6 Advanced features and optional capabilities

None of these are needed for normal use. Use them when the situation in the second column applies.

F23 Stronger protection for the API key

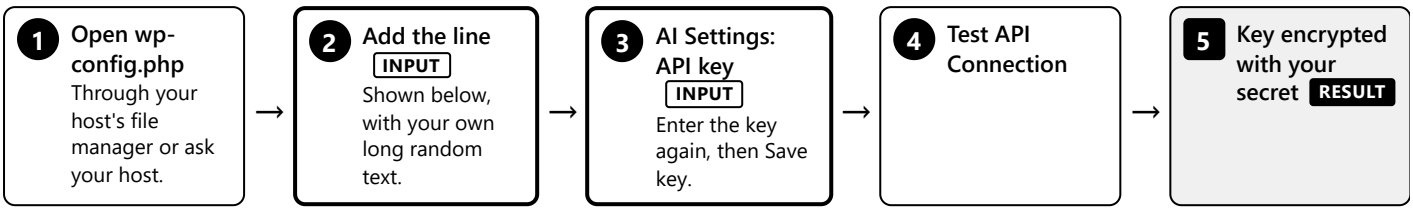
Your site's wp-config.php file, then AI Settings

Purpose. By default the key is encrypted with your WordPress salts. A separate secret, kept outside the database, protects it further.

You can. Add one line to wp-config.php, then save the key again.

Result. The AI Settings note about ZZZCOPY_SECRET_KEY no longer appears.

Next. Keep the secret safe. If it changes, enter the API key again.



The line for step 2: `define( 'ZZZCOPY_SECRET_KEY', 'long random text' );` Put it above the line that says to stop editing.

If the Dashboard ever says "The saved OpenRouter API key cannot be decrypted", the WordPress salts or this secret changed. Enter the key again on AI Settings.

Advanced capability	Use it when	Where, and the numbered steps
A different mode per category	Some topics should be reviewed, others published at once	Publishing: ① WordPress category mapping ② "Mode for this category": Draft or Automatic Publish ③ Save publishing settings (F9, 3.2)
Post into an existing WordPress category	Your site already has its own categories	Publishing: ① WordPress category mapping ② choose it under "WordPress category" ③ Save publishing settings (F9, 3.1)
Weighted rotation	Some categories matter more	① News Sources > Edit: set Weight ② Save category ③ Schedule: Rotation mode "Weighted random" ④ Save schedule (F5 3.4, F13 2.1)
A fixed category for a slot	A topic must appear at a set time	Schedule: ① Rotation mode "Choose per slot, round robin for the rest" ② Save schedule ③ choose the category under "Slot N" ④ Save schedule (F13 2.5)
Only some categories in rotation	Keep a category but rest it	Schedule: ① tick the ones to use under "Categories in rotation" ② Save schedule (F13 2.4)
Custom date range	Covering a past event	News Sources > Edit: ① Recency filter "Custom range" ② Custom start and Custom end ③ Save category. Past-Hour Posting must be off (F5 4.3, 4.4; F12)
Keyword rules	A broad source needs narrowing	News Sources > Edit: ① Required keywords ② Excluded keywords ③ Save category ④ Test search (F5 4.1, 4.2)
Duplicate and matching thresholds	Too many, or too few, stories count as duplicates	News Sources: ① Source and duplicate rules 2.10 to 2.13 ② Save changes (F6)
Prompt versions	A prompt change made articles worse	AI Settings: ① Prompt history ② Restore on the older version (F3, 6)
Test draft	See a full post before automation runs	AI Settings: ① Run test generation ② Create test draft (F4)
Release an image	An image may be used again	Images: ① Image history ② Release ③ confirm (F18)
Web-request cron and its token	Your host cannot run PHP from cron	Schedule: ① copy the second command ② add it to your cron ③ Create new token if it is exposed (F14)
Export logs	Keep a record, or share it with someone helping you	Logs: ① filters ② Apply filters ③ Export CSV (F17). This is the only export, and there is no import

7 Complete user journey

How the features work together, from installation to a published post, and what happens when a step cannot finish. Steps 1 to 7 are yours. Steps 8 to 15 run by themselves, every minute, even with the browser closed.

A. You: set up once (Section 5 has the details)

1 **Install and activate**
F1

→

2 **AI Settings** INPUT
Key, test, model, prompts. F2 to F4

→

3 **News Sources**
Categories and rules. F5, F6

→

4 **Authors** INPUT
Grant access. F7

↓ continue at **5**

5 **Publishing and Images** INPUT
Post author, mode, image rules. F9, F10

→

6 **Schedule**
Times, Past-Hour, rotation, stop limit, server cron. F11 to F15

→

7 **Dashboard: Start Automation**
F19

B. InkRush: runs by itself

8 **Find stories**
Google News RSS and publisher feeds of the category due next.

→

9 **Filter**
Age, keywords, duplicates.

→

10 **Read the source**
Accessible publisher text, at least 250 words, following robots.txt.

→

11 **Write the article and 20 tags**
Your prompts, your OpenRouter model.

↓ continue at **12**

12 **Check the article**
Length, tags, format, not cut off.

→

13 **Find the featured image**
Wikimedia Commons, licensed, never repeated.

→

14 **Wait for the slot**
Respects the daily maximum.

→

15 **Post, in the category's mode**

- **15a** **Draft** — You review it (F22).
- **15b** **Published** — Live on your site.

↓ continue at **16**

16 **You check** NEXT
Dashboard, Articles, Usage, Logs. F16, F17, F20, F21

→

17 **Then?**

- **17a** **Keep running** — Back to 8 for the next slot.
- **17b** **Pause or Stop** — F19. Start again any time.
- **17c** **Automatic stop** — A limit is reached (F15). Start again to reset.

C. If a step cannot finish

At step	What happened	What InkRush does	What you do
7	Something required is missing	Does not start, and lists it under "Needed before you can start"	Fix each item (Section 8)
8	Google News is blocked or changes	Keeps using publisher feeds	Add publisher feeds (F5), or untick Use Google News RSS (F6)
9	Too old, excluded or a duplicate	Skips it and logs why	Nothing, or loosen filters (F5, F6)
10	Paywalled, blocked, refused by robots.txt or too short	Records it and tries the next story. Never bypasses	Add feeds that post often (F5)
11	Bad key, no credits, or the model is gone	Pauses AI jobs. Research and posting of finished articles continue	Fix it (F2, F3), then Resume (F19)
12	Fails the checks	Holds it, never publishes it	Articles > Failed or held: read why, Retry or Skip (F16)
13	No usable image	Holds it and tries once more 6 hours later. With Past-Hour Posting, picks another story while there is time	Lower the minimum score or allow CC BY-SA (F10), then Retry (F16)
14	No article ready for the slot	Past-Hour Posting: skips that post. Otherwise follows "When a slot has no article"	Add sources, or adjust F11 and F12
15	WordPress cannot create the post, or the author is no longer active	Retries a few times, then holds it. An inactive author stops posting until fixed	Check Logs, fix the author (F7, F9), then Retry (F16)

At step	What happened	What InkRush does	What you do
–	The worker stops running	Dashboard shows Worker health: Stalled	Set up or check the server cron (F14)

8 Quick reference

No.	Feature	Where	Required settings	Start with
F1	**Install, upgrade, activate**	Plugins	None	① Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin
F2	**OpenRouter connection**	AI Settings	API key	① AI Settings ② paste the key ③ Save key
F3	**Model, limits, prompts**	AI Settings	Model identifier, Article prompt, Tag prompt (filled in)	① AI Settings ② Model and limits
F4	**Test generation**	AI Settings	Sample headline, Source text	① Test generation ② fill in ③ Run test generation
F5	**News categories**	News Sources	Name, one source, one day	① News Sources ② Add category or Edit
F6	**Source and duplicate rules**	News Sources	None	① News Sources ② Source and duplicate rules
F7	**Authors**	Authors	One Active author	① Authors ② Filter ③ Grant access
F8	**Multiple users mode**	Authors	An active author with a schedule ticked on and a post time	① Authors ② Schedule ③ Save schedule ④ Posting mode
F9	**Publishing settings**	Publishing	Post author	① Publishing ② Post author ③ Save
F10	**Image settings**	Images	None	① Images ② Search and quality
F11	**Publishing schedule**	Schedule	Valid Timezone (filled in)	① Schedule ② Publishing schedule
F12	**Past-Hour Posting**	Schedule	None	① Schedule ② Use Past-Hour Posting
F13	**Rotation and research**	Schedule	None	① Schedule ② Rotation mode
F14	**Server cron**	Schedule	None (recommended)	① Schedule ② Server cron ③ copy a command
F15	**Automatic stop**	Schedule	None	① Schedule ② Automatic stop ③ Save automatic stop
F16	**Articles**	Articles	None	① Articles ② Failed or held
F17	**Logs and CSV export**	Logs	None	① Logs ② filters ③ Apply filters or Export CSV
F18	**Image tools and history**	Images	Text for a preview	① Images ② Test tools
F19	**Automation controls**	Dashboard	Section 5 minimum setup	① Dashboard ② Start Automation
F20	**Dashboard monitoring**	Dashboard	None	① Dashboard ② Worker box
F21	**Usage**	Usage	None	① Usage ② OpenRouter totals
F22	**Review drafts and posts**	WordPress Posts	Draft mode, for drafts	① Posts > Drafts ② open ③ Publish
F23	**Stronger key protection**	wp-config.php	ZZZCOPY_SECRET_KEY	① wp-config.php ② add the line ③ save the key again
F24	**Data retention and removal**	Publishing	None	① Publishing ② Data retention and removal
F25	**Deactivate or delete**	Plugins	None	① Stop Automation ② Plugins ③ Deactivate

"Needed before you can start": what each message means

Message on the Dashboard	What to do
Add your OpenRouter API key on the AI Settings page.	F2, steps 1 to 3
The saved OpenRouter API key cannot be decrypted …	Enter the key again on AI Settings (F2, F23)
Enter an OpenRouter model identifier on the AI Settings page.	F3, 2.1
Enter the article prompt / the tag prompt on the AI Settings page.	F3, 3.1 and 3.2

Message on the Dashboard	What to do
Enter a valid timezone on the Schedule page.	F11, 2.4
A message about the Post author or author access	F7, then F9 2.4
Multiple users mode is on, but no active author has a schedule. …	Give an active author a schedule (F8, steps 2 to 4), or choose Single user mode (F8, 7.1)
Enable at least one category on the News Sources page.	F5, table B, 2b
These categories have no usable source: …	Add a topic address, search query or feed, or disable them (F5, 3.5 to 3.7)
These categories have no matching WordPress category: …	Tick "Create a WordPress category when none matches", or map each one (F9, 2.5 or 3.1)

> About this guide: every page, setting, option, default, range, button and message here was checked against the InkRush 1.9.0 code. WordPress's own screens (Plugins, Posts) are described as WordPress labels them, and may differ slightly between WordPress versions. No screenshots are included, so nothing here can show a key or private data. Support and contact: das.sagorwork@gmail.com.